LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Health and Allied Sciences (Nursing, Pharmacy, Allied Health, AYUSH): Class 6 to Career

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This document covers health careers other than MBBS and BDS, which are covered in the Science PCB document. Information is compiled from publicly available sources. Eligibility rules for allied health courses have changed recently (NEET is reported to be mandatory from 2026-27); items marked **[VERIFY]** are subject to confirmation against official notifications. See section 9 (Source and confidence log).

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build Science curiosity, empathy and communication; try first aid, Red Cross / Scouts, health clubs	Biology interest and service attitude
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Keep Biology and Chemistry strong; basic Maths is enough for most health courses	PCB stream in Class 11-12
Stream choice	After Class 10	Choose PCB (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) in Class 11-12 (PUC in Karnataka)	Eligibility for nursing, pharmacy, allied health, AYUSH, veterinary
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + NEET-UG (AYUSH, allied health) and KCET (nursing, pharmacy in Karnataka)	Merit seats via counselling
Degree	After Class 12	BSc Nursing, B.Pharm / Pharm.D, BPT, BSc MLT / Radiology / Optometry, BAMS / BHMS / BUMS / BNYS	Professional licence after council registration
Registration	After degree	Register with the relevant council (State Nursing Council, Pharmacy Council, NCAHP bodies, CCIM / CCH)	Right to practise
Postgraduate	2-4 years later	MSc Nursing, M.Pharm, MPT, MD (AYUSH), public health, hospital administration	Specialist, teaching and research roles

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: learn first aid, hygiene and health basics; join Red Cross, Scouts / Guides or school health clubs.
- Keep Biology and Chemistry strong; for B.Pharm (PCM route) keep Maths as well.

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Choose PCB. Add Maths if you want pharmacy via the PCM route or a keep-both-doors approach (PCMB).
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Prepare for NEET-UG (AYUSH, allied health, veterinary) and KCET (BSc Nursing and B.Pharm in Karnataka) together; boards still matter for the PCB percentage rule.
- Check age rules: minimum 17 years on 31 December of the admission year is quoted for nursing and AYUSH.

After Class 12: Degree

- BSc Nursing (4 yr); B.Pharm (4 yr); Pharm.D (6 yr); BPT (4.5 yr); BSc MLT, Radiology, Optometry (3-4 yr); BAMS / BHMS / BUMS / BSMS / BNYS (5.5 yr including internship).
- Counselling: KEA (Karnataka) for KCET seats and state AYUSH / NEET seats; AACCC for all-India AYUSH seats; deemed universities run their own processes.

After the degree: Registration and career

- Register with the relevant council; join hospitals, pharma companies, diagnostics, public health, research or start a practice or clinic.

3. Early preparation (Class 6-12)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
Red Cross / Scouts / first-aid and health clubs	Schools and NGOs	6-12	Service attitude and basic skills	Through the year
NSO / science olympiads	SOF and others	1-12	Biology and Science practice **[VERIFY]**	See Science PCB document
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: health careers need steady Biology and Chemistry marks and often a minimum PCB percentage (commonly 45%-50% General). Keep board marks healthy alongside entrance prep.

4. Entrance exams and counselling

BSc Nursing - Karnataka route	
Counselling body	KEA (via KCET) for government and most private RGUHS-affiliated colleges; RGUHS follows INC norms
Eligibility	10+2 with Physics, Chemistry and Biology; 45% aggregate in PCB for General, 40% for SC/ST (OBC per some listings); age 17 years on 31 December of the admission year **[VERIFY]**
Entrance	KCET (Karnataka); a government order of April 2023 is cited for KCET. NEET is reported as not required for Karnataka nursing; deemed universities (Manipal, Yenepoya) run their own tests. 2026 KCET was 23-24 April **[VERIFY]**
Outside Karnataka	AIIMS and some national institutes use NEET or their own tests **[VERIFY]**

B.Pharm, Pharm.D and D.Pharm	
Counselling body	KEA via KCET for government, aided and many private seats; private management quotas vary
Eligibility	B.Pharm: 10+2 with Physics, Chemistry and Biology or Maths; 45% General / 40% reserved per PCI norms (one source says 50%). Pharm.D: PCB / PCM or D.Pharm for lateral entry to 4th year. D.Pharm: 2-year diploma after PCB / PCM **[VERIFY]**
Entrance	KCET; NEET is not required; BITSAT also accepted at BITS for B.Pharm **[VERIFY]**
Postgraduate	M.Pharm via GPAT or state rules; GPAT details not confirmed **[VERIFY]**

Allied Health Sciences (BPT, BSc MLT, Radiology, Optometry and others)	
Regulator	National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions (NCAHP); 13 curricula notified so far (reported)
NEET rule	NCAHP reportedly told institutions that NEET is a basic eligibility criterion for allied and healthcare UG courses from 2026-27; Karnataka-specific rules are not confirmed **[VERIFY with KEA and RGUHS]**
Eligibility	10+2 with PCB (some courses accept PCM); minimum percentages per curriculum **[VERIFY]**

AYUSH (BAMS, BHMS, BUMS, BSMS, BNYS)	
Entrance	NEET-UG; only NEET-qualified candidates can join AYUSH counselling
Counselling	AACCC (aaccc.gov.in) for 15% all-India quota in government colleges, central universities, institutes and deemed universities; state counselling for 85% state quota (Karnataka: KEA **[VERIFY]**)
Eligibility	PCB; NEET percentile cutoff 50th for General / EWS and 40th for SC/ST/OBC; age 17 years by 31 December 2026 **[VERIFY]**
Seats	About 52,720 seats in 914 colleges across BAMS, BUMS, BHMS, BSMS and BNYS (reported) **[VERIFY]**

NEET-UG (reference)	
Details	Full NEET-UG rules, pattern and 2026 re-exam notes are in the Science PCB document

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
Public health, nutrition and dietetics, speech and audiology, occupational therapy, prosthetics	Allied and rehabilitation fields	Regulated by NCAHP or RCI; entry rules differ **[VERIFY]**
Clinical psychology and counselling	Mental health	RCI registration; see Arts and Humanities document **[VERIFY]**
Emergency medical technician, paramedic, nursing assistant (certificate / diploma)	Short-course health roles	Approved institutions; entry after Class 10 or 12 **[VERIFY]**

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
NEET-PG / NEET-MDS	NBEMS	MD / MS / MDS after MBBS / BDS	Once a year **[VERIFY]**
GPAT	NTA	M.Pharm	Once a year **[VERIFY]**
MSc Nursing, MPT and AYUSH PG entrance	Universities and AIAPGET	Postgraduate health courses	Varies **[VERIFY]**
CSIR-UGC NET / ICMR JRF	NTA / ICMR	Research	See Science PCB document **[VERIFY]**

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Health-sciences scholarships (state, institute, CSR)	State departments, colleges, foundations	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each provider **[VERIFY]**
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST) **[VERIFY: single source]**	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline **[VERIFY]**
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov **[VERIFY]**

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences and does not apply to professional health degrees. **[VERIFY]**

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BSc Nursing	4 yr	KCET (Karnataka)	Hospital and community nursing; State Nursing Council registration
B.Pharm / Pharm.D	4 yr / 6 yr	KCET	Pharmacy Council registration
BPT (Physiotherapy)	4.5 yr	NEET or state route **[VERIFY]**	NCAHP-regulated
BSc MLT / Radiology / Optometry / OT / Perfusion	3-4 yr	NEET or university entry **[VERIFY]**	Diagnostics and technician roles
BAMS / BHMS / BUMS / BSMS / BNYS	4.5 yr + 1 yr internship	NEET-UG + AYUSH counselling	AYUSH practice; CCIM / CCH registration
MBBS / BDS	5-5.5 yr	NEET-UG	See Science PCB document

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): St John's College of Nursing, MS Ramaiah Institute of Nursing, Manipal and Yenepoya universities, Government College of Pharmacy Bengaluru, RGUHS-affiliated colleges, AIIMS institutes, central AYUSH institutes. **[VERIFY availability, fees and admission route]**

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Nursing	Staff nurse, ICU / OT nurse, community health nurse, nurse educator, military nursing	MSc Nursing, PhD, specialisations
Pharmacy	Hospital pharmacist, clinical pharmacist, regulatory affairs, pharma sales and research	M.Pharm, MBA, PhD
Allied health	Physiotherapist, lab technologist, radiographer, optometrist, OT technician	MPT, MSc, specialisation
AYUSH	Ayurvedic, homeopathic, unani physician; wellness and yoga therapist	MD (AYUSH), research
Public health and administration	Public health officer, hospital administrator, health-tech roles	MPH, MBA Healthcare

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Science PCB: MBBS, BDS, veterinary and biology research (see Science PCB document).
- Agriculture and Veterinary: BVSc and allied animal-health careers (see Agriculture document).
- Arts and Humanities: psychology and counselling (see Arts and Humanities document).
- Defence: Armed Forces Medical Services and Military Nursing Service (see Defence document).
- Sports: sports medicine, physiotherapy and sports science (see Sports and Arts document).

9. Source and confidence log

Confidence reflects the type of source available. Items rely on publicly available secondary sources unless stated otherwise.

Item	Finding	Confidence
BSc Nursing Karnataka	KCET + KEA per April 2023 GO; NEET not required in Karnataka; 45% / 40%; age 17 by 31 Dec; deemed universities run own tests	Medium
B.Pharm / Pharm.D / D.Pharm	KCET + KEA; 45% / 40% (one says 50%); PCB or PCM; NEET not required; GPAT not confirmed	Medium / Low

Item	Finding	Confidence
Allied health	NCAHP reportedly made NEET mandatory from 2026-27; Karnataka rules not confirmed	Low-Medium
AYUSH	NEET-UG; AACCC 15% AIQ + central / deemed; state 85%; percentile 50 / 40; age 17 by 31 Dec 2026	Medium-High
Public health, clinical psychology, paramedic	Not researched in detail	Low

Still to verify on official sites

- NCAHP curricula and NEET mandate for each allied course; BPT entry route in Karnataka.
- KEA 2027 notification for nursing and pharmacy; seat matrices; AYUSH counselling in Karnataka; D.Pharm and Pharm.D entry.
- Official sources: kea.kar.nic.in, rguhs.ac.in, inc.gov.in, pci.nic.in, ncahp.gov.in, aaccc.gov.in, nmc.org.in, neet.nta.nic.in.
- Dates shift every year. Replace "tentative month" with the official notification date before publishing.

ONE-PAGE GIST: Health and Allied Sciences

Items marked **[VERIFY]** are subject to confirmation against official notifications (see the detailed document).

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	First aid, health clubs; keep Biology and Chemistry strong
After Class 10	Choose PCB; PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + NEET-UG and KCET; check PCB percentage rule
After Class 12	BSc Nursing, B.Pharm, BPT, BSc MLT / Radiology, BAMS / BHMS / BUMS
Registration	Register with State Nursing / Pharmacy / allied or AYUSH council
Career	Nurse, pharmacist, therapist, technologist, AYUSH doctor, public health

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
KCET (Karnataka)	April (2026: 23-24)	BSc Nursing and B.Pharm via KEA counselling	No negative
NEET-UG	May (2026 re-exam: 21 Jun)	AYUSH, allied health (reported), veterinary; 180 Q, 720 marks	+4 / -1
AYUSH counselling	After NEET results	AACCC (15% AIQ) + state counselling (85%)	Percentile cutoff 50 / 40
Allied health	From 2026-27 **[VERIFY]**	NEET reported mandatory; check NCAHP curriculum	Check notification

Key rules: nursing needs 45% PCB (General) and age 17 by 31 Dec; AYUSH needs NEET; allied health is moving to NEET. **[VERIFY]**

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), post-matric schemes via NSP / SSP. **[VERIFY]**

Careers: nurse, pharmacist, physiotherapist, lab technologist, radiographer, Ayurvedic / homeopathic doctor, public health officer.

Want a personalised roadmap or counselling? Contact LessonPlan, Yelahanka, Bangalore.